2.4. Statements

Expressions and operators are important, but you'll also need to use statements to work effectively in CoffeeScript. Statements are executed but don't produce a value. When expressions are executed, they *do* produce a value:

```
balance = 1000
while balance > 0
  balance = balance – 100
```

Here, the `while` keyword is a statement, so it doesn't have a value but is an instruction only. In comparison, `balance – 100` is an expression and it has a value. That value is assigned to the variable `balance`.

In CoffeeScript you should always prefer expressions because expressions will lead to simpler programs—you'll learn more about that in later chapters. This section takes some common statements from JavaScript and demonstrates how they're used in CoffeeScript as part of an expression. Before getting to the individual examples, you'll look at the basic syntactic parts, or anatomy, of an expression.

2.4.1. Anatomy

Things that are only statements in JavaScript can be used as expressions in CoffeeScript. An example of this is the `if` statement, as shown by figure 2.2.

Figure 2.2. Expression and statement anatomy